Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

Thursday 11 June 2026
Morning (Time: 1 hour 30 minutes)

PAPER REFERENCE
1HI0/33

History

Paper 3: Modern depth study

Option 33: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

Sources/Interpretations Booklet

Do not return this Booklet with the question paper.

Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.
This booklet contains Source B, Source C, Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 for use with Question 3 on the question paper.

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Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.

Sources for use with Questions 3(a) and 3(c).

Source B

Source B: From an interview with Lenray Gandy in 2015, reflecting on his childhood attendance at a Mississippi Freedom School in 1964.

That summer transformed our community in Mississippi. It made us realize we had constitutional rights. The northern volunteers initiated an important shift, encouraging us to organize our own protests and boycotts. We viewed those volunteers as activists for freedom, and it inspired us to join the campaign ourselves.

Source C

Source C: From security logs compiled by Freedom Summer organizers in June 1964, detailing opposition encountered by volunteers.

June 16: Philadelphia. School building intended for Freedom classes destroyed by fire. June 21: Brandon. Church facility bombed. McComb. Dwellings of two civil rights workers damaged by explosives. June 22: Clarksdale. Four volunteers detained by police during voter registration drive; released after several hours. June 23: Philadelphia. Burned vehicle located; three volunteers reported missing. June 25: Ruleville. Local church burned. Itta Bena. Two organizers threatened by local residents and ordered to leave town.

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Interpretations for use with Section B.

Interpretations for use with Questions 3(b), 3(c) and 3(d).

Interpretation 1

Interpretation 1: From a modern historical study.
The Freedom Summer campaign achieved significant educational outcomes. Organizers established over forty Freedom Schools, serving thousands of local Black students with a curriculum focusing on literacy and African American history. These schools aimed to develop local leadership to sustain the movement. Additionally, voter registration classes prepared thousands of residents to apply for voting rights.

Interpretation 2

Interpretation 2: From a different historical perspective.
For many participants, the Freedom Summer was characterized by violence and disappointment. Activists faced numerous arrests, physical assaults, and several deaths, while actual voter registration gains were minimal. Furthermore, the influx of white volunteers from northern universities created internal tensions, as some Black organizers resented their prominent leadership roles.

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